What is a project?

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- Is a task with an objective carried out by time, space and rules which has to follow some steps to reach the goal. It is subject to constraints (budgetary, physical, physiological, legal…), which depend on the specific context of the considered project.
- Key difference : goal ≠ means

2 Examples :

- An academic project (What are we doing now)
- Personal projects: health (loose weight) finance (create an startup)
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Steps of an overall project implementation:

- preliminary market research : compare the different suppliers, the different materials…
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Guideline of the call proposal

1. **Initiation or Programmation**
   MAKE proposal
2. **Identification (tree design)**
   Identify stakeholders.
3. **Formulation**
   Develop a detailed plan including tasks, timeline, resources, budget, and risks. Peliminary market research, compare the diffrenet suppliers, materials, etc
4. **Financing decision**
   Carry out the project plan by performing the tasks and managing the team.
5. **Implementation**
   Deliver the project
6. **Controlling and Evaluation**
   Track progress, measure performance, and make adjustments as needed to stay on track and evaluate.

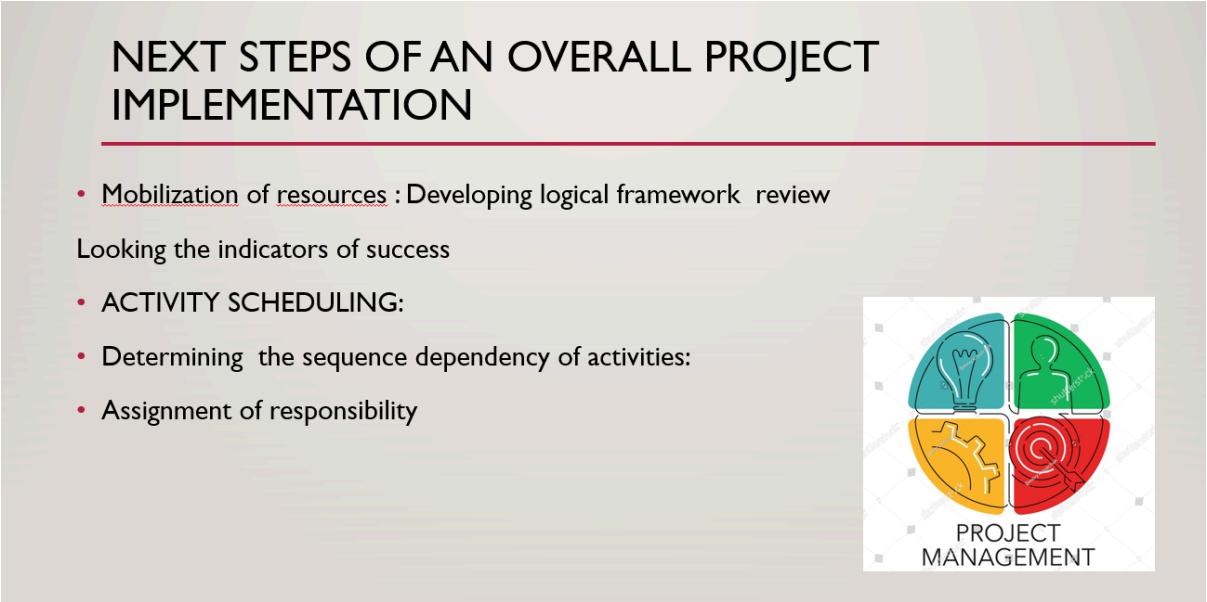
- find the needed human resources and organise them
- acquire the needed materials
- advertising and communication (toward the (potential) customers)
- launch the activities (construction, production…) in conformity with the schedule
- post-launch monitoring and continuous improving

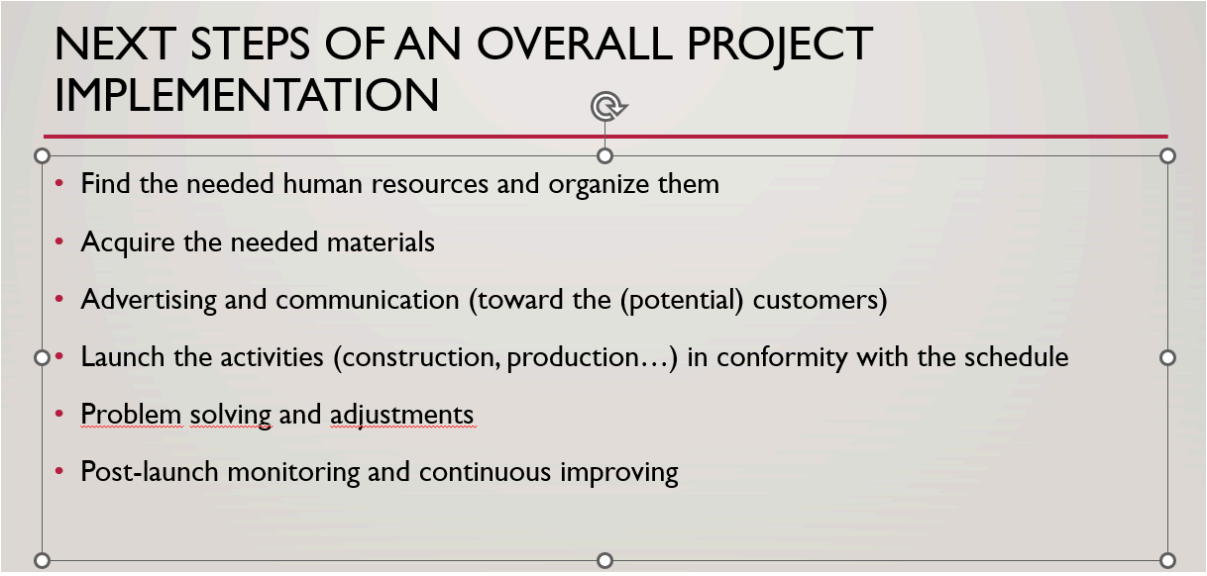
NEXT STEPS OF AN OVERALL PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION

- Mobilization of resources : Developing logical framework review

Looking the indicators of success

- ACTIVITY SCHEDULING:
- Determining the sequence dependency of activities:
- Assignment of responsibility





Guinea Bissau

Guinea Bissau Country Profile :

Guinea Bissau is a small West African country on the Atlantic coast, bordered by Senegal to the north, Guinea to the east and south, and the ocean to the west; its capital is Bissau. The national territory includes both the low-lying mainland and the Bijagós Archipelago, a chain of dozens of islands (World Bank). Covering roughly 36,000 square kilometers, the country features mangrove-lined estuaries along the coast and savanna landscapes inland (Central Intelligence Agency [CIA]). The climate is tropical with a marked rainy season followed by a dry season (CIA), shaping agriculture and daily life.

The population is a little over two million, with a very youthful age structure and a median age below twenty years (CIA). Guinea-Bissau is ethnically diverse, including Balanta, Fula,

Manjaco, Mandinka, Papel, and other communities (CIA). Portuguese is the official language, but Guinea-Bissau Creole serves as the lingua franca for most people, alongside several African languages used in local contexts (CIA). Islam and Christianity are the largest religions, while traditional beliefs remain influential in many areas (Bertelsmann Transformation Index [BTI]).

Politically, Guinea-Bissau is a semi-presidential republic with a president as head of state and a prime minister leading the government (CIA). Since independence, however, recurrent instability, frequent cabinet changes, and occasional coups have constrained institutional consolidation (BTI; Freedom House; World Bank). Governance challenges persist, including limited administrative capacity, corruption risks, and tensions between branches of government (BTI).

The economy is among the poorest globally and depends heavily on agriculture, especially cashew nuts, which dominate export earnings (CIA). Subsistence farming of rice and groundnuts is widespread, and fishing supports livelihoods in coastal zones and the islands (BTI). Industrial activity is minimal and services remain underdeveloped (CIA), while infrastructure gaps, exposure to commodity price swings, and climate variability weigh on growth and investment (BTI; World Bank).

Social indicators mirror these constraints. Poverty affects a majority of households (UNDP), literacy remains low (63.9% in 2022 according to the CIA World Factbook), and access to quality health and education is uneven, as highlighted by the UNDP's Human Development Reports and the Bertelsmann Transformation Index (BTI). Maternal and child health outcomes lag behind global averages, and life expectancy is modest (CIA). Despite these headwinds, Guinea-Bissau participates actively in regional and international organizations—such as ECOWAS, the African Union, the United Nations, and the Community of Portuguese Language Countries—seeking cooperation, investment, and support for reforms (World Bank).

<u>the problem of solid waste management in Guinea Bissau:</u>

<u>Problems</u>

When looking at the current system of waste management in Bissau, the first striking point is the weakness of collection and disposal services. According to a recent assessment by the World Food Programme's Logistics Cluster (WFP), the city generates several hundred tonnes of waste each day but only a fraction is effectively collected. This means that large amounts of rubbish accumulate in the streets, near markets, and in informal dumps. According to a UN-Habitat country brief, the municipal sanitation service suffers from chronic shortages of trucks, fuel, and maintenance capacity, which explains the irregularity of collection routes and the long delays before waste is removed.

Another difficulty lies in the absence of controlled treatment. As the Yale Environmental Performance Index (Yale EPI) notes, almost all waste ends up in open dumps with no liners,

leachate controls, or gas management. In practice, a lot of it is simply burned in the open to reduce volume, which exposes residents to smoke and toxic emissions. I came across an academic analysis by Nantungue (2024) which stresses that the lack of reliable data and performance monitoring makes planning almost impossible, because authorities do not know precisely how much waste is produced, what it contains, or where it goes. From what I have read, plastics are particularly problematic: UN reports on plastic pollution in West Africa show how lightweight packaging easily spreads into drains, mangroves, and coastal waters, where it is nearly impossible to recover (UNEP / WHO / NGO briefs).

Institutional factors also play a role. The World Bank overview of Guinea-Bissau explains that responsibilities are fragmented between local and national authorities, with outdated regulations and very weak enforcement. Tariffs do not cover real service costs, so fee collection brings little income. Donor-funded projects have piloted improvements, for example landfill rehabilitation with the Fukuoka method supported by UNDP, but these remain small-scale (UNDP Procurement Notices (2025)). In my view, the real issue is the lack of sustainable funding and coordination that would allow such pilots to be extended to the whole city.

Impacts on the Population

The consequences for the population are serious and visible. As highlighted by UN-Habitat, uncollected waste piles up in residential areas and attracts flies, rodents, and mosquitoes. This creates ideal conditions for malaria, diarrhea, and other vector-borne or waterborne diseases (UN-Habitat). During the rainy season, drains in Bissau are frequently clogged with plastics and organic matter, leading to increased urban flooding. The leachate from decomposing waste then contaminates shallow wells, as documented by UN-Habitat and the EU's COPIP Project Fiche. In practice, this means that households relying on local water sources face direct health risks, as documented by UN-Habitat and the EU's COPIP Project Fiche.

Another impact, which I found described in several NGO and UN reports, is air pollution from open burning. Families living near dumpsites inhale smoke and particles every day, and children playing around waste areas are particularly vulnerable. Informal waste pickers, who recycle plastics and metals to earn a living, work without protective equipment and are constantly exposed to sharp objects, smoke, and contaminated materials. This illustrates how poverty forces people into unsafe livelihoods, while at the same time their activity provides the only real recycling in the city.

Environmental consequences are also evident. According to the EU's COPIP project fiche on Bissau's waste sector, plastics and other litter accumulate in mangrove ecosystems and on tidal flats. These are critical nursery areas for fish, so the pollution undermines local fisheries, which many families depend on (COPIP Project Fiche). Flooding caused by clogged drains in Bissau frequently damages homes, roads, and market areas, imposing additional costs on micro-businesses and discouraging tourism, as highlighted by the EU's COPIP Project Fiche and UN-Habitat reports. I found it particularly striking that, as Freedom House and World Bank reports suggest, poor waste management even has political and economic implications:

it signals weak governance, reduces the attractiveness of the capital, and makes it harder to attract investment (Freedom House; World Bank).

Finally, the social dimension is important. Service inequality is very clear: low-income neighborhoods receive the least regular collection and therefore face the heaviest exposure to waste and flooding. Women are particularly affected, both as caregivers responsible for household sanitation and as vendors in waste-filled markets, as highlighted by UN-Habitat and UNDP reports. Children lose school days because of illness, while families spend scarce resources on medical treatment (UNDP; World Bank). From what I read in the UNDP project documents, when pilot projects for improved collection and safer disposal are implemented, the benefits are immediate: cleaner neighborhoods, less flooding, and better working conditions for informal workers (UNDP). For me, this shows that solutions exist, but they require continuity of funding, citizen participation, and stronger institutions to scale them up.

<u>Sources for the Country Profile</u>

- World Bank — Guinea-Bissau: Overview
- CIA World Factbook — Guinea-Bissau
- UNDP — Human Development Reports: Country Profile Guinea-Bissau
- Freedom House — Guinea-Bissau Country Report
- Bertelsmann Transformation Index (BTI) — Guinea-Bissau Country Report

<u>Sources for the Problem of Solid Waste Management in Guinea-Bissau</u>

- Logistics Cluster (WFP) — Guinea-Bissau: Waste Management and Recycling Infrastructure Assessment
- UN-Habitat — Urbanization in Guinea-Bissau: Building Inclusive & Sustainable Cities
- Yale Environmental Performance Index (EPI 2024) — Country Profile: Guinea-Bissau
- Nantungue, F. (2024) — Analysis of the Municipal Solid Waste Management System in Bissau
- World Bank (2025 update) — Guinea-Bissau Overview: Urban Services and Institutional Capacity
- UNDP Procurement Notices (2025) — Safe and Sustainable Waste Management and Disposal in Guinea-Bissau
- COPIP Project Fiche (EU pre-feasibility) — Bissau Integrated Solid Waste and Sanitation
- UNEP / WHO / NGO briefs — Plastics Pollution and Waste System Pressures in Africa (including GAIA reports)